LESSON 10

The Foundation for Life

Primary Scripture: 2 Timothy 3:16–17; Matthew 7:24–27

Supporting Scriptures: Psalm 1:1–3; 1 Peter 2:2; Colossians 3:16; James 1:22–25

Memory Verse: 2 Timothy 3:16–17

Central Teaching Truth

God's Word is trustworthy and sufficient to teach, correct, and train believers, so that they build their lives on Christ through faithful obedience.

Lesson Objective

Understand the authority and purpose of Scripture and develop a realistic practice of reading, interpreting, and applying it.

Introduction

A house can look impressive, but its strength becomes clear when a storm comes. Jesus compared the wise listener who obeys His words to a builder who chooses a firm foundation. Similarly, Christian maturity rests not only on hearing Scripture, but on receiving and practicing it.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read 2 Timothy 3:16–17 and Matthew 7:24–27.

1. What four uses of Scripture does Paul identify in 2 Timothy 3:16?

_____

_____

2. What distinguishes the wise builder from the foolish builder in Jesus' illustration?

_____

_____

2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

Scripture is breathed out by God and equips His people for every good work. Its teaching should be understood in context, not merely quoted to support our own wishes. In Matthew 7, both builders hear; the difference is whether they act on Jesus' words. Scripture points us to Christ, gives us a standard for truth, exposes sin, corrects our course, and trains us for faithful living.

Teaching Diagram — Building on a Firm Foundation

FOUNDATION	DAILY PRACTICE	FRUIT
Christ and His Word	Read and understand	Sound judgment
God's truth	Believe and obey	Faithful choices
Biblical correction	Continue in community	Growing maturity

3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. Is there a biblical command I know but have postponed obeying?

_____

_____

2. What might help me read the Bible consistently and interpret it in context?

_____

_____

A Simple Seven-Day Bible Reading Plan

Day	Read	One truth to practice
Day 1	Psalm 1:1–3	_____
Day 2	Matthew 7:24–27	_____
Day 3	2 Timothy 3:14–17	_____
Day 4	James 1:19–25	_____
Day 5	Colossians 3:12–17	_____
Day 6	John 15:1–11	_____
Day 7	Psalm 119:9–16	_____

Personal Action Step

Read one passage each day. Write down one observation, explain its meaning in context, and follow through on one appropriate action.

Group Discussion

How can we distinguish knowing a Bible verse from understanding and obeying its message?

Closing Prayer

Father, give us a hunger for Your Word. Help us handle Scripture faithfully, follow Jesus' teaching, and live what we learn. Amen.

LESSON 11

Victorious Living

Primary Scripture: 1 Corinthians 10:13; James 1:12–15

Supporting Scriptures: Matthew 4:1–11; Psalm 119:11; Galatians 5:16; James 1:2–4; Romans 8:28

Memory Verse: James 1:2–3

Central Teaching Truth

God provides grace and a way to endure temptation; through Christ, believers can resist sin, persevere through trials, and grow in faith.

Lesson Objective

Distinguish temptation from sin, identify scriptural responses to both temptation and hardship, and build habits of reliance on Christ.

Introduction

A believer may face pressure to compromise at work, at home, or in private. Experiencing temptation does not automatically mean we have sinned. Jesus Himself was tempted yet remained without sin. God calls us to respond with truth, prayer, and obedient choices rather than trusting willpower alone.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read James 1:12–15 and 1 Corinthians 10:13.

1. According to James, what happens when sinful desire is welcomed and allowed to grow?

_____

_____

2. What reassurance and responsibility are found in 1 Corinthians 10:13?

_____

_____

2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

Temptation is an enticement to sin; it is not itself the same as choosing sin. James traces how unchecked desire can lead to sinful action. God does not tempt us to evil, and He is faithful amid our trials. His provided way of escape may require leaving a situation, speaking the truth, seeking help, or choosing obedience. Trials can also produce steadfastness (James 1:2–4); this does not mean suffering is pleasant or that every hardship can be explained.

Teaching Diagram — Responding to Temptation

RECOGNIZE	RESPOND	CONTINUE
Notice the pressure	Recall God's Word	Choose obedience
Identify the desire	Pray and seek help	Remain accountable
Do not excuse sin	Take the way of escape	Confess and return when you fall

3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. What kind of temptation is most likely to catch me unprepared?

2. What practical escape route could I choose before that situation occurs?

When Hardship Comes

Read James 1:2–4 and Romans 8:28. Biblical joy during trials is confidence in God's character and purpose, not pretending that pain does not hurt. We can lament honestly, pray for help, and trust God to work faithfully, even when we do not understand the outcome.

3. What truth from Scripture can I remember during a current hardship?

Personal Action Step

Choose one temptation or trial to pray over this week. Memorize a relevant verse, identify one wise action, and seek support from a trusted mature believer when needed.

Group Discussion

What difference does it make to see victory as faithful dependence on Christ rather than never experiencing a struggle?

Closing Prayer

Lord Jesus, strengthen us in temptation and steady us in trials. Teach us to use Your Word, seek Your help, and return quickly when we fail. Amen.

LESSON 12

Dynamic Prayer

Primary Scripture: Philippians 4:6–7; Matthew 6:9–13

Supporting Scriptures: 1 Peter 5:7; Matthew 7:7–11; Psalm 145:1–3; 1 John 1:9; 1 Thessalonians 5:18; 1 John 5:14–15

Memory Verse: Philippians 4:6–7

Central Teaching Truth

Prayer is a trusting response to the Father who knows and cares for His children; it includes worship, confession, thanksgiving, and requests aligned with His will.

Lesson Objective

Grow in confidence that God cares, learn the different dimensions of biblical prayer, and develop a thoughtful habit of praying.

Introduction

Some believers readily bring major emergencies to God but hesitate to pray about ordinary decisions or worries. Yet Jesus taught that our heavenly Father knows our needs. Prayer is not a technique for forcing an outcome; it is communion with the God who hears us and calls us to trust His wisdom.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read Philippians 4:6–7 and Matthew 6:9–13.

1. What instructions and promise does Philippians 4 give to anxious believers?

2. Which concerns appear in the prayer Jesus taught His disciples?

2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

Prayer begins with who God is: our Father, holy and worthy of honor. Jesus teaches us to seek God's kingdom and will, ask for daily provision, acknowledge our need for forgiveness, and seek help against temptation. Philippians encourages prayer with thanksgiving and promises God's guarding peace in Christ—not automatic fulfillment of every request. God hears according to His will (1 John 5:14–15).

Teaching Diagram — Four Dimensions of Prayer

PRAISE	CONFESSION	THANKSGIVING	REQUESTS
Who God is	Where I need mercy	What God has given	My needs and others' needs

3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. Which part of prayer do I practice easily, and which have I neglected?

2. What ordinary concern have I been carrying without bringing it to God?

A Guided Prayer Practice

Praise: Name one attribute of God and why it matters.

Confession: Acknowledge a specific sin and seek His mercy in Christ.

Thanksgiving: Thank God for a particular evidence of grace.

Requests: Pray for your needs and the needs of others, yielding to His will.

3. Who will I pray for regularly this week, and what will I ask God to do?

Personal Action Step

Set aside ten minutes on five days this week. Use the four dimensions of prayer without treating them as a rigid formula. Keep a brief prayer journal and notice how Scripture shapes your requests.

Group Discussion

How can we pray boldly while also submitting sincerely to God's wisdom and timing?

Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father, thank You for welcoming us into Your presence through Christ. Teach us to praise, confess, thank You, and bring our needs with trust. Let Your will shape our prayers. Amen.